

Quentin Tarantino's

debut feature, the stylish thriller *Reservoir Dogs*, announces a confident **new talent**.

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1992

Danish directors Lars von Trier and Thomas Vinterberg take an artistic “vow of chastity” with their **Dogme 95 manifesto**.

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1995

David Lynch continues to **explore nonlinear narratives** in *Lost Highway*; Curtis Hanson conjures up the spirit of **film noir** with *LA Confidential*.

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1997

Ang Lee brings *wuxia* to an international audience with *Crouching Tiger, Hidden Dragon*.

↑
2000

1994



With a story by Quentin Tarantino, Oliver Stone shocks and **challenges audiences with the violence** of *Natural Born Killers*.

1996



Joel and Ethan Coen find warmth in a **tale of icy violence** with *Fargo*, while David Cronenberg **provokes audiences** with *Crash*.

1998



Vinterberg's **first Dogme movie**, *Festen*, is shot using a handheld digital camera.

2002



Contemporary **gang life** is vividly portrayed in *City of God*, while *Gangs of New York* depicts 19th-century crime.

As this book nears the end of its broad sweep of movie history, the time has come to introduce Quentin Tarantino. By the early 1990s, a century of movies was available to filmmakers to pay homage to and to repurpose. Tarantino—a movie obsessive who filled his movies with endless nudges and nods to that past—was a controversial figure from the moment the world saw his debut *Reservoir Dogs*. But no one could question the excitement he generated.

Beyond Hollywood

From the 1990s onward, Hollywood was increasingly one part of a bigger story. The curious audience was looking far afield, and rather than the occasional box-office breakout, it was becoming the

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When people ask me if I went to film school, I tell them “no, I went to films.”

Quentin Tarantino

norm for movie lovers to celebrate the movies of Southeast Asia, Turkey, India, and Latin America. Cultures clashed, to glorious effect: *Crouching Tiger Hidden Dragon* was a martial arts extravaganza steeped in the Chinese tradition of

wuxia but purpose made by its Taiwanese-American director Ang Lee to be accessible to audiences across the world. From Brazil, Fernando Meirelles's *City of God* applied the stylistic swagger of Martin Scorsese to a story set in the favelas of Rio.

Digital revolution

A less heralded revolution also stirred in the last days of the 20th century. Since the dawn of cinema, filmmakers had been just that: film was not just the name of the art form, it was what physically went into cameras and projectors. In 1998, the Danish family drama *Festen*, filmed according to the rules of the Dogme 95 manifesto, became the first high-profile movie to be shot on digital video, then mostly used in cheap home